



RAOH

— R e s e a r c h e r s —

RESEARCH. DISCOVER. IMPACT.

Advancing knowledge.
Creating real-world impact.



Discussion

Purpose of the Discussion

The Discussion section interprets the results, explains their meaning, compares them with previous studies, and highlights their implications. It is the most analytical part of the manuscript.

Structure of the Discussion

1. Summary of Main Findings

Start by briefly restating the most important results.

Example:

This study found that poor sleep quality was significantly associated with lower academic performance among medical students.

2. Interpretation of Findings

Explain what the results mean and why they might have occurred.

Example:

This association may be explained by impaired cognitive function, reduced concentration, and increased fatigue among students with poor sleep quality.

3. Comparison with Previous Studies

Compare your findings with existing literature.

- Agreement with studies
- Differences from studies
- Possible reasons for differences

Example:

These findings are consistent with previous studies that reported a negative association between sleep deprivation and academic performance among university students.

4. Possible Explanations

Discuss biological, psychological, or social explanations.

Examples:

- Stress
 - Academic workload
 - Lifestyle factors
 - Mental health issues
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5. Strengths and Limitations

Strengths

- Large sample size
- Validated tools
- Clear methodology

Limitations

- Cross-sectional design (no causality)
 - Self-reported data
 - Single institution
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6. Implications

Explain why the findings matter.

Examples:

- Educational interventions
 - Sleep hygiene programs
 - Curriculum planning
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7. Recommendations for Future Research

Suggest what should be done next.

Example:

Longitudinal studies are needed to explore causal relationships between sleep quality and academic performance.

Writing Tips

- Interpret, do not just repeat results.
- Compare with literature.
- Use scientific reasoning.
- Be balanced (not exaggerated).
- Stay aligned with your results.

Common Mistakes

- ✗ Repeating results without interpretation
 - ✗ Introducing new results not shown earlier
 - ✗ Overstating causality in cross-sectional studies
 - ✗ Ignoring contradictory studies
 - ✗ Making unsupported claims
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Good Example Sentence

Correct:

The observed association between poor sleep quality and lower academic performance may be explained by reduced cognitive efficiency and increased daytime fatigue.

Incorrect:

Poor sleep causes low grades in all students.

AI Usage Note

AI may assist with language refinement, but authors are fully responsible for interpretation, accuracy, and comparison with literature. AI should not replace scientific judgment or critical analysis.

Final Checklist

- ✓ Main findings summarized
 - ✓ Results interpreted
 - ✓ Compared with literature
 - ✓ Limitations included
 - ✓ Implications discussed
 - ✓ No new data introduced
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Golden Rule

The Discussion answers: “What do the results mean, and how do they fit into existing knowledge?”